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For Your Eyes Only

100-person strong Anglo-Eastern Ship Management Ltd saved a whopping 80 percent of their costs on communication, when they implemented Virtual Private Network (VPN). Here's how you can communicate securely and cheaply over the Internet using VPNs

Aparna Krishnakumar

The Internet is an indispensable tool. Whether it's for communication—e-mail or browsing—or for research, or running corporate Web sites, most business houses rely on the World Wide Web. But for companies that have branches spread across the globe, the major question is—how secure is the Internet?

The issue does assume serious proportions, given that almost all corporate communication and research today, is done via the Internet. Your company could be headquartered in, say, Bangalore, and have regional offices dotting numerous places across India, or even abroad. In such cases, the Internet is the only bridge that connects the distant elements of your business.

It is common knowledge that the WWW plays reluctant host to a range of viruses, trojans, social engineering attacks, DDoS attacks, and other forms of cyber-nuisance. And it needs little mention that business houses, which rely heavily on the Web for communication, take a major risk in doing so. Is there an absolutely secure way for companies to exchange information over the Internet?

A Virtual Private Network or VPN could just be that answer. A VPN uses public networks such as the Internet and exactly the same physical infrastructure of cable and routers. In doing this, it not only drastically cuts down costs, but also offers smooth services with fool-proof security.

The Company

The Anglo-Eastern Ship Management Ltd is located in a quaint area of north-central Mumbai. It advertises itself as a liaison company. In Mumbai, the company is the largest sup-

